

# Country PhD Intelligence: Japan

Academic Intelligence Dossier • 2026-10-03

Country Code: JP

Primary Currency: JPY

Execution Date: 2026-10-03

Target PhD Field: Edge Computing, Edge AI & Distributed Systems

## 1. Country Overview & Research Ecosystem

Japan offers an internationally renowned doctoral research ecosystem characterized by world-class university laboratories, competitive national and institutional funding structures, and clear pathways for international doctoral scholars.

\* **Primary Funding Vehicle:** MEXT Government Doctoral Scholarship, JSPS Research Fellowships & University Fellowships

\* **Immigration & Dependant Policy:** International doctoral students holding a College Student (Ryugaku) visa may sponsor spouse and children under Dependent (Kazoku Taizai) status of residence.

\* **Official Guidance:** [https://www.isa.go.jp/en/applications/procedures/zairyu\\_nintei10\\_19.html](https://www.isa.go.jp/en/applications/procedures/zairyu_nintei10_19.html)

## 2. Executive Intelligence Metrics

\* **Total Top Universities Identified:** 8

\* **Total Vetted Professors Monitored:** 8

\* **Available Doctoral Funding Schemes:** 4

\* **Key Application Deadline:** 2026-11-30

## 3. Discovered Universities & Suitability

| University                                                 | Relevant Departments                                                                                                       | Research Suitability | Funding Rating | Official Portal |
|------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------|----------------|-----------------|
| Osaka University                                           | Graduate School of Information Science and Technology, Department of Computer Science                                      | 66.5%                | High           | Portal          |
| The University of Tokyo                                    | Graduate School of Information Science and Technology, Department of Electrical Engineering and Information Systems (EEIS) | 62.5%                | High           | Portal          |
| Kyoto University                                           | Graduate School of Informatics, Department of Communications and Computer Engineering                                      | 59.5%                | High           | Portal          |
| Tokyo Institute of Technology (Institute of Science Tokyo) | School of Computing, Department of Computer Science                                                                        | 59.5%                | High           | Portal          |
| Keio University                                            | Graduate School of Science and Technology, Department of Information and Computer Science                                  | 59.5%                | High           | Portal          |

|                          |                                                                                                   |       |      |        |
|--------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------|------|--------|
| <b>Tohoku University</b> | Graduate School of Information Sciences, Research Institute of Electrical Communication (RIEC)    | 59.5% | High | Portal |
| <b>Waseda University</b> | Faculty of Science and Engineering, Department of Computer Science and Communications Engineering | 59.5% | High | Portal |
| <b>Nagoya University</b> | Graduate School of Informatics, Department of Computing and Software Systems                      | 59.5% | High | Portal |

## 4. Top Vetted PhD Supervisors & Relevance

| Professor                       | University                                      | Priority Tier | Research Fit | Recruitment Status | Profile Link |
|---------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------|---------------|--------------|--------------------|--------------|
| <b>Prof. Hiroshi Esaki</b>      | The University of Tokyo                         | Tier 1        | 100.0%       | CONFIRMED_ACTIVE   | Dossier      |
| <b>Prof. Hiroki Matsutani</b>   | Keio University                                 | Tier 1        | 95.1%        | CONFIRMED_ACTIVE   | Dossier      |
| <b>Prof. Koji Yatani</b>        | The University of Tokyo                         | Tier 1        | 88.8%        | CONFIRMED_ACTIVE   | Dossier      |
| <b>Prof. Kenjiro Cho</b>        | The University of Tokyo / IJ Research Lab       | Tier 1        | 82.5%        | CONFIRMED_ACTIVE   | Dossier      |
| <b>Prof. Toyotaro Suzumura</b>  | The University of Tokyo                         | Tier 1        | 68.2%        | STRONG_EVIDENCE    | Dossier      |
| <b>Prof. Hideyuki Kawashima</b> | Keio University                                 | Tier 1        | 68.2%        | STRONG_EVIDENCE    | Dossier      |
| <b>Prof. Masaki Aida</b>        | Tokyo Metropolitan University / Keio University | Tier 2        | 79.2%        | STRONG_EVIDENCE    | Dossier      |
| <b>Prof. Fumio Teraoka</b>      | Keio University                                 | Tier 2        | 53.0%        | POSSIBLE           | Dossier      |

## 5. Major Doctoral Funding Schemes & Scholarships

### *Japanese Government (MEXT) Doctoral Scholarship (University & Embassy Track)*

\* **Provider / University:** Ministry of Education, Culture, Sports, Science and Technology (MEXT), Japan (All Designated National Universities (UTokyo, Kyoto, Tokyo Tech, Osaka, Keio, etc.))

\* **Funding Type:** FULLY\_FUNDED

\* **Tuition Coverage:** Full 100% waiver of university examination, admission, and tuition fees

\* **Stipend / Salary:** 145,000 - 148,000 JPY/month tax-free living allowance + roundtrip international airfare

\* **International Eligibility:** ELIGIBLE

\* **Dependant Support:** PERMITTED

\* **Application Deadline:** 2026-11-30

\* **Official Source:** <https://www.studyinjapan.go.jp/en/planning/scholarships/mext-scholarships/>

### *JSPS Research Fellowship for Young Scientists (DC1 / DC2)*

- \* **Provider / University:** Japan Society for the Promotion of Science (JSPS) (All Japanese Universities & Research Institutes)
- \* **Funding Type:** FULLY\_FUNDED
- \* **Tuition Coverage:** Institutional tuition waiver or subsidy typically granted to awardees
- \* **Stipend / Salary:** 200,000 JPY/month monthly research stipend + up to 1,500,000 JPY/year Grants-in-Aid for Scientific Research (KAKENHI)
- \* **International Eligibility:** ELIGIBLE
- \* **Dependant Support:** PERMITTED
- \* **Application Deadline:** 2026-05-15
- \* **Official Source:** <https://www.jsps.go.jp/english/e-pd/index.html>

### ***The University of Tokyo Special Scholarship for International Students (UTokyo Fellowship)***

- \* **Provider / University:** The University of Tokyo (The University of Tokyo)
- \* **Funding Type:** FULLY\_FUNDED
- \* **Tuition Coverage:** Full tuition fees covered through institutional grants
- \* **Stipend / Salary:** 150,000 - 200,000 JPY/month research grant stipend
- \* **International Eligibility:** ELIGIBLE
- \* **Dependant Support:** PERMITTED
- \* **Application Deadline:** 2026-11-15
- \* **Official Source:** <https://www.u-tokyo.ac.jp/en/prospective-students/fellowship.html>

### ***JST SPRING Doctoral Research Fellowship***

- \* **Provider / University:** Japan Science and Technology Agency (JST) (Partner Japanese Universities (Kyoto, Tokyo Tech, Osaka, Keio, Tohoku))
- \* **Funding Type:** FULLY\_FUNDED
- \* **Tuition Coverage:** Full tuition exemption or institutional coverage
- \* **Stipend / Salary:** 180,000 - 200,000 JPY/month living grant + 300,000 - 500,000 JPY/year research budget
- \* **International Eligibility:** ELIGIBLE
- \* **Dependant Support:** PERMITTED
- \* **Application Deadline:** 2026-12-01
- \* **Official Source:** <https://www.jst.go.jp/jisedai/en/>

## **6. Strategic Application Timeline & Next Steps**

1. **Weeks 1–4:** Review individual 33-section professor dossiers under `professors`.
  2. **Weeks 5–6:** Conduct tailored email outreach referencing recent publications and active laboratory grants.
  3. **Weeks 7–8:** Formalize 5-page research proposal aligned with the supervisor's documented testbeds.
  4. **Target Deadline:** Submit institutional application ahead of **2026-11-30**.
- \*Report compiled automatically by the Global Country-Based PhD Funding and Supervisor Intelligence Engine on 2026-10-03.\*